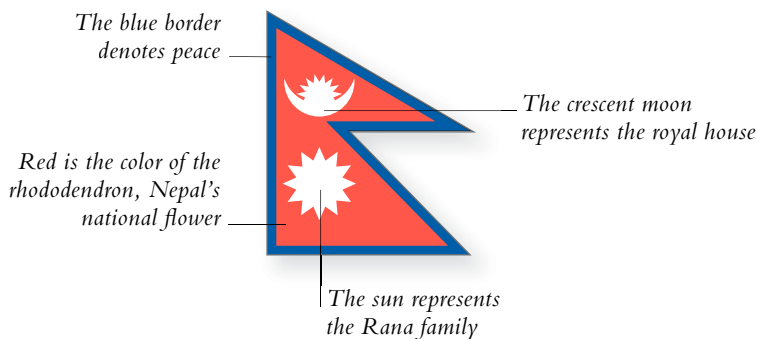


Nepal

Ratio: 4:3 (plus border) **Adopted:** December 16, 1962 **Usage:** National and Civil



Asia



From 1960 **Nepal** was ruled by an absolute monarchy. This regime ended in 1991 when the first multiparty elections were held.

The flag of Nepal is the only national flag that is not rectangular or square. Originally, two separate triangular pennants were flown one above the other; these were then joined to form a single flag. Its crimson red is the color of the rhododendron; the country's national flower. Red is also the sign of victory in war. The blue border is the color of peace.

THE SUN AND THE MOON

Until 1962, the flag's emblems, the sun and the crescent moon, had human faces. They were removed to modernize the flag. The sun retains the face on the Royal Standard. The crescent represents the royal house and the sun denotes the Rana family, who were hereditary prime ministers until 1961.

THE ROYAL STANDARD (1960–2008)

The Royal Standard shows a rampant lion holding a lance with a flag



The sun has a face, as did the national flag until 1962